

OSMC: A Friendly Media Centre For Your Raspberry Pi

A reliable open source media player comes handy when working on media files. A media centre software called Open Source Media Center (OSMC) can help you get support from an expansive range of systems, including Windows, iOS, Linux as well as other devices like Raspberry Pi. OSMC is a Debian Jessie-driven Linux distribution that runs Kodi application on devices, including Apple TV and Vero in addition to Raspberry Pi.

Setting up version 2017.01-1

OSMC is compatible with Raspberry Pi 1, 2 and 3. However, version 2 or higher is desired for optimal performance. To set up OSMC on your Raspberry Pi, first download the OSMC application on your computer. The installation will require a confirmation of the language and the device where the distro is intended to be used. Confirm the latest version of the software and click to continue.

In the next step, you will be prompted to select the storage type. It can be a USB stick, NFC device or even internal storage. Usually, Raspberry Pi users choose to use SD cards.

Select the storage appropriately and move on to the next step. Here, you will be asked to confirm whether you will be using a wireless network (Wi-Fi), wired network (Ethernet cable) or would like to configure manually. Select the suitable network and continue. OSMC will start

downloading on the SD card or selected storage and install after the download.

Now, plug in the storage to your Raspberry Pi device. OSMC will start to install in your Pi system. After the installation completes, select your language and time zone. Set up your device name and accept the licence agreement. Once all the steps are successfully followed, OSMC will configure in your laptop with Kodi appearing in the front end. You can perform all the functions of Kodi on your Raspberry Pi.

The open source goodness

The OSMC interface is very compact with an attractive metallic appearance. The left panel consists of explorable options where you can play various media files like videos, movies, TV shows, music and pictures. All the media is categorised in folders, making the user interface (UI) comprehensive and easy to find. OSMC supports a large range of codecs, allowing most of the video formats and resolutions to run smoothly.

A menu called 'My OSMC' in the left panel enables you to configure your setup including Raspberry Pi configuration. You can mark your most visited files as Favourites and access them quickly from the menu. Settings menu allows you to make OSMC setup changes, including date, time, language and so on.

OSMC keeps the system updated. It is responsible for



Fig. 1: OSMC installation wizard (Source: seo-michael.co.uk)



Fig. 2: Storage selection prompt



Fig. 3: Prompt for choice of connection to the web